

5.6.3 Hijack This

An advanced anti-spyware tool, you'd only need it if your resident anti-spyware application fails to rectify a "situation." HT includes many tools; it is a Registry checker / editor, it can check the start-up files list, it can delete locked files at boot-time. HT was an independent entity till all the good press made it a target for acquisition by Trend Micro, an anti-virus manufacturer. But it retains its name and functionality.

For best results, to ensure that spyware can be easily deleted, it is recommended to boot the system in safe mode (by pressing [F8] while booting) before running HT.

When HT starts up, you are presented with a window that offers to perform a scan. On running the scan, all Registry entries that are deemed harmful are listed. Selecting an entry and clicking the "Info on the Selected item" reveals additional information about the object and the proposed action HT will take to counter it. You can select and delete entries from the list. HT makes a back-up of the deletions, so if needed, any of the deleted Registry keys can be restored. HT can also create a log file of the scan, which can prove useful if you'd like others to suggest which entries to mark for deletion.

The Config button reveals additional tools. "Delete a File on Reboot" can be used to delete a file that is presently



A typical scan results window, with info on one entry

being locked by a process and hence cannot be deleted. Malware applications are usually launched at boot-time and remain in memory; this makes it difficult to delete the file, and stopping the particular process is fruitless since they are restarted almost immediately. This tool will be of use in such cases. The Uninstall Manager can be used to delete entries from the Add / Remove Programs applet. The Main button opens the settings dialog where HT's behaviour can be modified; the start page for IE can also be